

THE FORMATION OF THE ISLAMIC NORMATIVE SYSTEM in the 7th–11th centuries

A Prosopographical Analysis of the Intellectual Elite
Monograph

Ryszhanov Serik

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Author: Ryszhanov Serik Bolatjanovich

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ABSTRACT

Who precisely wrote the Islamic normative system? This question has not been posed systematically. Biographical data on the individuals who created the hadith collections, legal madhhabs, theological systems, and normative grammar of the Arabic language are available. Yet no monograph has covered this entire corpus simultaneously — across all disciplines, the whole formative period, and both the Sunni and Shi'i traditions.

The present monograph undertakes this task. The method is prosopography: systematic biographical study of a defined social group. The data comprise 97 Sunni and ~27 Shi'i verified figures, selected by four operational criteria: possession of an individual article in Encyclopaedia Iranica or EI2, or citation in three or more biographical dictionaries; founding of a school, codification of a discipline, or status as a key node in the transmission of knowledge; active activity in the 7th–11th centuries.

An extended authorship typology is introduced. Type A — manuscript within 50 years of the author's death, attribution uncontested. Type B — manuscript within 200 years. Type C-1 — charismatic-doctrinal authority: Shi'i imams whose "authorship" is a theological construct. Type C-2 — school-attributive authority: scholars whose works have not survived but whose influence was transmitted through disciples.

Central conclusion: The normative authority of the Islamic system of the 7th–11th centuries was constructed through an Arab genealogical and prophetic frame, while the written codification of that authority was carried out predominantly by the Persian intellectual elite, formed in a cultural milieu with a developed tradition of written codification from Sasanian civilisation. The pattern has been verified at five independent levels. The mechanism of transmission is supported by case studies of four cases: three legal norms (waqf, mut'a, inheritance) and one ritual case (the five daily prayers).

KEYWORDS

prosopography; Islamic normative system; intellectual elite; cultural translation; Zoroastrian zone; Sasanian tradition; authorship typology; hadith scholarship; fiqh; kalām; Sufism; Shi'i tradition; imamate; mawālī; institutional imprinting; Late Antique synthesis; waqf; mut'a; inheritance.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

PUBLICATION DATA

ABSTRACT

KEYWORDS

PREFACE

INTRODUCTION

PART I. CONTEXT AND METHOD

Chapter 1. Sources, Method, Sample

- 1.1. Primary Sources (P1/P2)
- 1.2. Biographical Dictionaries (S2)
- 1.3. Source Bias
- 1.4. Three Selection Criteria
- 1.5. Acknowledgement of Lacunae
- 1.6. Why Women Are Absent from the Main Corpus
- 1.7. Authorship Typology A/B/C-1/C-2
- 1.8. Ethnicity: An Operational Category
- 1.9. Two Alternative Explanations

Chapter 2. The Sasanian Context: From Background to Mechanism

- 2.1. Four Sources of Zoroastrian Law
- 2.2. The Zoroastrian Zone
- 2.3. Christians and Syrians: Intermediaries
- 2.4. Jewish and Sabian Traditions
- 2.5. The Conquest Did Not Create a Vacuum

PART II. CODIFICATION OF THE SACRED CORPUS

Chapter 3. Hadith Scholarship: Seventeen out of Twenty-One

Chapter 4. Tafsīr and Grammar: Normative Arabic in Non-Arab Hands

PART III. THE NORMATIVE SYSTEM

Chapter 5. Fiqh: Three of Five Links

Chapter 6. Kalām: Three Schools — One Pattern

PART IV. INTELLECTUAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Chapter 7. Translations and Philosophy: Non-Muslims as Intermediaries

Chapter 8. Mechanisms of Transmission

Chapter 9. The Shi‘i and Western Islamic Traditions

PART V. SYNTHESIS AND THEORETICAL MODEL

Chapter 10. Quantitative Analysis

Chapter 11. Theoretical Model

11.1. Institutional Imprinting

11.2. Three Unverifiable Transitions

11.3. Case Studies: Four Cases of Varying Evidential Strength Supporting the Cultural Translation

Hypothesis

11.3.1. Waqf

11.3.2. Mut‘a

11.3.3. Inheritance (‘aṣaba)

11.3.4. The Five Daily Prayers: Ritual Codification as the Fourth Case

11.3.5. Comparative Conclusion

11.4. Responses to Objections

11.5. Positioning within Historiography

CONCLUSION

RESEARCH LIMITATIONS

CONTRIBUTION

CHAPTER 12. VERIFICATION THROUGH INDEPENDENT ARABIC SOURCES

12.1. Khalīfa ibn Khayyāt: An Arab Control

- 12.2. Ibn Saʿd: An Arab Author, an Arab Milieu
- 12.3. Bulliet's Data: The Conversion Curve
- 12.4. al-Muwattaʿ: An Arab Hadith Corpus
- 12.5. Analytical Conclusion: A Falsifiability Test

APPENDIX A. Sunni Prosopographical Table

APPENDIX B. Shiʿi Prosopographical Table

APPENDIX C. Authorship Typology A/B/C-1/C-2

APPENDIX D. Regional Centres

APPENDIX E. Bibliography of Primary Sources

APPENDIX F. Bibliography of Secondary Literature

APPENDIX G. Extended List of Candidates

PREFACE

The starting observation is a single one: the question of who precisely created the Islamic normative system in its classical form has not been posed systematically or quantitatively. Apologetic literature reproduces traditional attributions; critical literature attacks individual texts or figures without posing the question of the system as a whole. The present position is different: the object is not the content of hadiths nor the biography of any particular scholar, but the composition of the intellectual elite — who the people were who created the system, and whether there are structural patterns in that composition.

This framing is not polemical. The conclusion that the codification of the Islamic normative system was carried out predominantly by the Persian intellectual elite does not devalue the system, its normative status, or the cultural contribution of the Arab tradition. It registers a structural pattern. The criteria applied in this work — verifiability of biographical data, reproducibility of the sample, explicit acknowledgement of limitations — are universal to historical prosopography.

The monograph is written for specialists in Islamic studies, historical prosopography, comparative law, and the methodology of the humanities. The Shiʿi tradition is included in the main corpus on equal terms with the Sunni tradition. Arabic terminology is introduced at first use.

The present monograph is logically connected to the monograph "Hadith Scholarship as an Institution of Tradition" (Ryszhanov, 2026): the former establishes the epistemic limitations of hadith scholarship as a system; the present one shows by whom and in what cultural milieu that system was created. Together they form a two-level argument about the nature of the Islamic normative tradition.

INTRODUCTION

The Islamic normative system is the body of disciplines developed by the Muslim scholarly tradition for the production, transmission, evaluation, and application of normative knowledge. Its core consists of: hadith scholarship — the science of traditions attributed to the Prophet; fiqh — Islamic jurisprudence; uṣūl al-fiqh — the methodology of law; kalām — Islamic theology; tafsīr — Quranic exegesis; and the grammar and lexicography of the Arabic language.

The system was created in the 7th–11th centuries. This period is formative: by its end all the principal disciplines had been codified, the four Sunni madhhabs canonised, the hadith collections recognised as authoritative, and Ashʿarite theology established as the dominant theological school. In the Shiʿi tradition the same period was marked by the creation of the Four Books and the formation of rationalist Imami jurisprudence.

The central question is: who precisely carried out this codification? What was the ethnic, cultural, and religious background of the people who created the system? This question cannot be posed from within the tradition — it requires an external analytical standpoint.

The argument is constructed in layers. Part I establishes the methodological framework and historical context. Parts II–IV analyse the disciplines through three analytical axes: textual codification, the normative system, and intellectual infrastructure. Part V synthesises the data and formulates the theoretical model, including case studies of four cases of varying evidential strength. The Shiʿi tradition is analysed in Chapter 9.

The work is positioned in dialogue with key scholarship. Schacht (1950) showed the late formation of fiqh in a Persian milieu — the present study verifies this prosopographically. Crone (1987) advanced the hypothesis of Sasanian law's influence — the present study translates it into a structurally verifiable pattern supported by four case studies. Gutas (1998) analysed the translation movement — the present study extends that analysis to all disciplines. Savant (2013) investigated Persian cultural memory — the present study verifies this quantitatively. Jaques (2006) called for a prosopography of the formative period — the present study fulfils this call, extending coverage to both traditions.

PART I. CONTEXT AND METHOD

CHAPTER 1. SOURCES, METHOD, SAMPLE

The aim of this chapter is to show on what basis the data rest, how the figures were selected, and what the data are in principle capable of proving.

1.1. Primary Sources (P1/P2)

P1 designates materials contemporary with the events described: the Qur'ān, early inscriptions, coins, papyri of the 7th–8th centuries, Pahlavi legal documents before 651 CE, the Khuzistan Chronicle, and the Armenian historian Sebeos. PVII–VIII PP2 designates sources within 200 years of the events described. The systemic lacuna of 651–750 CE for Persian-language material is acknowledged as a structural limitation: this is precisely the period of transition from Persian to Arabic written culture, and documentation of this transition is extremely sparse.

1.2. Biographical Dictionaries (S2): What They Prove

The principal source base consists of biographical dictionaries (ṭabaqāt). Sunni SS2 sources: Ṭabaqāt al-Shīrāzī; Tārīkh Baghdād of al-Khaṭīb al-Baghdādī — 7,800 biographies of Baghdad scholars; Ibn Khallikān, Wafayāt al-a'yān; Encyclopaedia Iranica; Encyclopaedia of Islam. Shi'i SS2 sources: Rijāl al-Najāshī; al-Fihrist of al-Ṭūsī; Ikhtiyār Ma'rifat al-Rijāl of al-Kashshī. All these sources are — SS2: written 200–400 years after the figures they describe. Biographical dictionaries record not only actual history but also the ideology of their own time — a retrospective construction of authority (Jaques 2006). This is acknowledged as a structural limitation.

1.3. Source Bias and Correction Methods

Al-Khaṭīb al-Baghdādī (a Shāfi'ī) is disproportionately critical of Ḥanafīs. The Ash'arite redaction of Sufi biographies normalises mystical concepts. Sunni sources marginalise Shi'i figures. The correction method is cross-verification through several independent sources. A concrete example: the account of the Zoroastrian origin of Abū Ḥanīfa's family from the Tārīkh Baghdād is verified through Encyclopaedia Iranica, which records it on the basis of an independent Iranian tradition.

1.4. Three Selection Criteria

The present study does not aim at exhaustive enumeration — it aims at an analytically relevant body of figures with maximum institutional influence. Three operational inclusion criteria: possession of an individual article in Encyclopaedia Iranica or EI2, or citation in three or more biographical dictionaries; founding of a school, codification of a discipline, or status as a key node of knowledge transmission; active activity in the 7th–11th centuries. For each figure in Appendices A and B the specific criterion of inclusion is indicated.

A fourth operational criterion: the existence of written codification of the madhhab or discipline within the 7th–11th centuries (Type A or B), or verified written codification by disciples in the same period (Type C-2). This criterion distinguishes Abū Ḥanīfa (codified by Abū Yūsuf and al-Shaybānī in the 8th century) from al-Awzā'ī (whose school did not produce a written canon in the 7th–11th centuries — see Appendix G).

Comparison with analogues: Ahmed (2011) — 5 figures, one milieu, one period. Jaques (2006) — 784 biographies, one school, one region, XVth century. The present study — ~124 figures, all disciplines, both traditions, the entire formative period. When figures are added to the corpus chronologically, the ratio of origins stabilises after ~90 Sunni figures — fluctuations do not exceed ±3%.

1.5. Acknowledgement of Lacunae

The Western Islamic tradition (Andalusia, Kairouan) — partially represented. The Zaydī branch of Shi‘ism — minimally: it did not produce a written canon in the 7th–11th centuries comparable to the Imami Four Books; systematisation of the Zaydī tradition belongs to the 12th–13th centuries.

1.6. Why Women Are Absent from the Main Corpus

The prosopographical base contains no female figures as codifiers of disciplines. This is not an omission of the study — it reflects the structure of the sources. Biographical dictionaries systematically excluded women from the category of codifiers of normative knowledge. Rābi‘a al-‘Adawiyya (714–801, Arab, Basra) is mentioned in the analysis of Sufism but not included in the main corpus: by the criteria of §1.4 she did not found a school nor codify a discipline in written form. The very absence of women from the sources is a historical testimony to the gender structure of intellectual authority, not a defect of method.

1.7. Authorship Typology A/B/C-1/C-2

The present study introduces four types of authorship because the standard category of “author” conceals fundamentally different situations. Type A — direct verification: manuscript within 50 years of the author's death, attribution uncontested. Examples: al-Māwardī, al-Ṭahāwī, al-Kulaynī. Type B — indirect verification: manuscript within 200 years. Al-Bukhārī's Ṣaḥīḥ: al-Bukhārī died in 870 CE, earliest manuscripts — 9th–10th centuries — Type B.

Type C-1 — charismatic-doctrinal authority: Shi‘i imams whose “authorship” is a consequence of the doctrine of the imam's infallibility. This is a methodological category describing the type of documentary evidence available to historical inquiry. Type C-2 — school-attributive authority: scholars whose oral teaching was transmitted by disciples but whose own works have not survived. Abū Ḥanīfa — Type C-2: the al-Fiqh al-akbar, traditionally attributed to him, is dated by Wensinck to the mid-X10th century — 200 years after his death.

The distinction between C-1 and C-2 is fundamental. Shi‘i imams (C-1) are the source of normative authority by theological definition. Sunni jurists (C-2) are the source of the school tradition by the historical fact of transmission.

Epistemological caveat: types C-1 and C-2 differ qualitatively from A and B in the nature of the evidence. C-1 is a theological construct (the doctrine of the imam's infallibility); C-2 is the historical reality of material loss. In the present study this condition is observed: Shi‘i imams (C-1) form a separate Level I, not counted in the quantitative table of §10.1. Sunni C-2 figures (Abū Ḥanīfa) are included with explicit notation of the epistemic status of the attribution.

1.8. Ethnicity: An Operational Category

"Ethnic origin" in the present study is an operational category derived from sources, not a biological reality. Where biographical data indicate only a nisba (geographical epithet), a figure is classified as "from a Persian cultural milieu," not as "ethnically Persian." Where sources contain direct biographical information about the family, the formulation "Persian origin" is used. This distinction is explicitly indicated for each figure in the appendices.

1.9. Two Alternative Explanations

A serious reviewer will raise two questions. First: does the predominance of Persian figures simply reflect demography? If 60–70% of the authors of Arabic-language literature in the 8th–11th centuries were non-Arabs (Bulliet 1979, Savant 2013), then 60% in the sample of the present study is not "disproportionate." Response: the issue is not absolute disproportion but disproportion relative to political dominance. The control group — the political elite of the same period — was predominantly Arab. If demography were the explanation, Persians would have dominated politically as well. This contrast is a structural pattern, not a demographic artefact.

Second question: urbanisation. Persian cities (Nīshāpūr, Bukhārā, Rayy) were the largest centres of literacy. Response: Persian urban centres possessed a developed written infrastructure inherited from Sasanian civilisation. The observed correlation between urbanisation and the concentration of scholars is consistent with the hypothesis rather than refuting it. Urbanisation is a probable mechanism, not an alternative explanation.

Third question: the linguistic paradox. If Persians dominated codification, why did Arabic rather than Persian become the language of fiqh? Response: Arabic was the language of legitimation (the Qur‘ān, the Prophet), not of knowledge. Precisely because Arabic was a foreign language for Persian scholars, it

required codification — normative grammar, dictionaries, exegesis. Sībawayhi wrote the grammar of Arabic precisely because Arabic was not his mother tongue. Arabs did not write grammars of their own language — it required no codification as a native tongue. The paradox is explicable: Persian authorship of the written system and the Arabic language of that system are not a contradiction but a structural necessity.

Fourth question: survival bias. Could Persian dominance be explained by better preservation of eastern manuscripts? Test: Khalīfā ibn Khayyāṭ (Arab author, Basra) and Ibn Saʿd (Arab author, Medina/Baghdad) — their texts have survived and they are of Arab origin. If Arab authors had systematically disappeared from history, their texts would not have reached us. They have reached us — and they reproduce the same pattern. Survivor bias does not explain Persian dominance.

CHAPTER 2. THE SASANIAN CONTEXT: FROM BACKGROUND TO MECHANISM

The aim of this chapter is to show the specific institutional structures inherited by Islam from preceding traditions. Not cultural coexistence, but the continuity of institutional forms.

2.1. Four Sources of Zoroastrian Law

The Zoroastrian legal system possessed four sources: the Avesta (sacred text), oral tradition (zand), the consensus of the mōbeds, and judicial practice (kardāg). The structural parallel with Islamic uṣūl al-fiqh (Qurʾān, sunna, ijmāʿ, qiyās) is noted in the comparative literature (Jany 2005, 2012) and is structurally comparable. Direct borrowing requires a separate case study for each norm. The land tax system (kharāj) was adopted by the Abbasid administration — one of the most documented cases of direct institutional continuity.

2.2. The Zoroastrian Zone: A Geographical Category

"The Zoroastrian zone" is a geographical and cultural, not confessional, category. It designates the territories of the Sasanian Empire (224–651 CE) or its enduring cultural influence, where Zoroastrian culture had dominated before Islam but other traditions coexisted. Specific territories: Khurāsān (Nīshāpūr, Merv, Tūs, Bukhārā, Tirmidh), Fārs (Shīrāz), Khūzistān (Tustar), Ṭabaristān (Āmul), Khwārazm, Rayy, Balkh, Kabul. Not all figures from this zone were Zoroastrians — they were Persian Muslims, carriers of the cultural memory of Sasanian civilisation.

2.3. Christians and Syrians: Intermediaries

Nestorian schools in Jundīshāpūr and Edessa preserved the Greek scientific tradition in Syriac translation. Syriac functioned as a mediating language between Greek and Arabic throughout the 8th–9th centuries. Yaḥyā ibn ʿAdī (Nestorian Christian, logician, died 974) — one of the key transmitters of Aristotelianism and the teacher of several generations of Islamic philosophers.

2.4. Jewish and Sabian Traditions

The Babylonian Talmud was codified in Sasanian Iraq (5th–6th centuries) — in the same milieu where early Islamic fiqh was later formed. The Harranian Sabians preserved the Greek astronomical tradition and became one of the sources of the exact sciences in Islamic civilisation through Thābit ibn Qurra and his school.

2.5. The Conquest Did Not Create a Vacuum

The Arab conquest of Iran (633–651 CE) reoriented existing institutions without creating a vacuum. The jizya and dhimma system preserved the institutional identity of non-Muslim communities for generations. The mawālī system allowed non-Arabs to integrate without loss of cultural memory. The Abbasid Revolution of 750 — the victory of the Khurasanian (Persian) military and intellectual elites — created the political conditions for Persian dominance in the emerging normative system. It is precisely after 750 that intensive codification of hadiths, fiqh, and theology begins.

PART II. CODIFICATION OF THE SACRED CORPUS

Analytical axis: who recorded the sacred text and in what language?

CHAPTER 3. HADITH SCHOLARSHIP: SEVENTEEN OUT OF TWENTY-ONE

3.1. Composition of the Corpus

The corpus includes 21 key figures: the authors of the Kutub al-Sitta (the six canonical Sunni collections), the founders of ʿilm al-rijāl (transmitter criticism), and the principal systematisers of hadith knowledge. For

each figure, place of birth or cultural milieu, authorship typology, and verification sources have been verified. 17 of the 21 figures are from a Persian cultural milieu or the Zoroastrian zone. The authors of five of the six canonical Sunni collections: al-Bukhārī (Bukhārā), Muslim (Nīshāpūr), Abū Dāwūd (Sijistān), al-Tirmidhī (Tirmidh), al-Nasā'ī (Nasā) — all from Khurāsān. The sole Arab author among the six is Mālik ibn Anas (Medina). The founders of 'ilm al-rijāl — 'Alī ibn al-Madīnī, Abū Ḥātim al-Rāzī, Ibn Abī Ḥātim al-Rāzī — all from a Persian milieu.

3.2. All Six Canonical Collections — Type B

None of the six Sunni canonical collections is Type AA: autographs have not survived. Al-Bukhārī's Ṣaḥīḥ: al-Bukhārī died in 870 CE, earliest manuscripts — 9th–10th centuries. All six are Type BB. This is consistent with the monograph "Hadith Scholarship as an Institution of Tradition" (Ryszhanov, 2026): the system verifies a report's belonging to the tradition but not its authentic transmission from the primary source.

3.3. Conclusion

The Arab tradition concerning the Prophet was canonised predominantly in the Persian intellectual milieu of the 8th–10th centuries. This is a verified structural pattern. The direct causal connection between the origin of hadith scholars and the content of the collections is the subject of the case studies in Chapter 11.

CHAPTER 4. TAFSĪR AND GRAMMAR: NORMATIVE ARABIC IN NON-ARAB HANDS

4.1. Exegetes

The foremost exegetes of the formative period: Muqātil ibn Sulaymān (Balkh, Type C-2), al-Ṭabarī (Āmul, Type A), al-Wāḥidī (Nīshāpūr, Type A), al-Zamakhsharī (Khwārazm, Type A), al-Tha'labī (Nīshāpūr, Type A). All are from the Persian cultural milieu of Khurāsān. Al-Ṭabarī — the most authoritative tafsīr: the manuscript tradition begins during the lifetime of his disciples.

4.2. The Sībawayhi Paradox

Normative Arabic grammar was created by Sībawayhi (Shīrāz → Basra, Persian milieu) — a man for whom Arabic was not his mother tongue. His al-Kitāb — Type BB. The Kufan grammatical school was developed by al-Farrā' (Persian milieu, Kufa). The normative Arabic dictionary was created by al-Jawharī (Fārāb, Kazakhstan, Turkic origin) — al-Ṣiḥāḥ, Type AA. Normative Arabic as the instrument of the normative system was created and standardised with disproportionate participation by non-Arabs.

4.3. Conclusion

The normative grammar of Arabic was written by a Persian. The normative dictionary — by a Turk. This is direct structural evidence of cultural translation at the level of the instrument itself.

PART III. THE NORMATIVE SYSTEM

Analytical axis: who determined what is correct and what is prohibited?

CHAPTER 5. FIQH: THREE OF FIVE LINKS

5.1. The Ḥanafī Chain

The directly verified chain of the Ḥanafī madhhab (>550 million followers): Ibrāhīm al-Nakha'ī (Kufa, Arab) → Ḥammād ibn Abī Sulaymān (Kufa, Persian milieu) → Abū Ḥanīfa (Kufa, Type C-2; family from Kabul, Zoroastrian origin per Encyclopaedia Iranica) → Abū Yūsuf (Kufa, Arab) → al-Shaybānī (Kufa, Syrian/Kufan). Three of five links — Persian milieu. Ḥanafī normative system in written form — project of Abū Yūsuf and al-Shaybānī, not Abū Ḥanīfa (Type C-2).

5.2. Regional Variants Confirm the Model

Ibn Abī Zayd al-Qayrawānī (Berber, 922–996, Type A) codified the Mālikī madhhab for North Africa — same model on Berber soil: a non-Arab elite codifies. Al-Muzanī (Persian milieu, Egypt, Type A) systematised the Shāfi'ī madhhab. Without them both madhhabs would not have been codified in written form.

5.3. Conclusion

The Persian cultural milieu is disproportionately represented in the formation of the Ḥanafī madhhab at the level of the chain of transmission. This is a verified structural pattern — not a claim about the direct transfer of specific norms.

CHAPTER 6. KALĀM: THREE SCHOOLS — ONE PATTERN

6.1. *Mu'tazilism: Six out of Seven*

Six of seven key Mu'tazilī figures from Persian cultural milieu: 'Amr ibn 'Ubayd (father Persian), Abū al-Hudhayl, al-Nazzām, al-Jubbā'ī, al-Ka'bī, 'Abd al-Jabbār — all Persian origin. Wāṣil ibn 'Aṭā' — origin disputed: EI Iranica indicates Persian roots; EI2 notes only mawlā status; origin classified as "disputed."

6.2. Ash'arism: Through a Persian Teacher

Al-Ash'arī (874–935, Arab, Basra) was a pupil of al-Jubbā'ī (Persian milieu, Khūzistān). The dominant Sunni theology was created by an Arab through a Persian teacher. His successors — al-Isfarāyīnī (Khurāsān), al-Juwaynī (Nīshāpūr) — are both from a Persian milieu. Al-Juwaynī was the teacher of al-Ghazālī.

6.3. Sufism: Nine out of Eleven

Ibrāhīm ibn Adham (Balkh), al-Muḥāsibī (Persian milieu, Basra), Abū Yazīd al-Bisṭāmī (Bisṭām, Iran), Sahl al-Tustarī (Tustar, Khūzistān), al-Ḥallāj (Tūr, Fārs), al-Junayd (Nihāwand, Iran), al-Sarrāj (Ṭūs), al-Qushayrī (Nīshāpūr), al-Ghazālī (Ṭūs, Khurāsān). 9 of the 11 key Sufi theorists are from the Persian cultural milieu of Khurāsān. The final synthesis — al-Ghazālī (Ṭūs) — is Persian.

6.4. Conclusion

Mu'tazilism, Ash'arism, Sufism — three independent currents of Islamic theology — were formed with disproportionate participation by the Persian intellectual milieu. The pattern is reproduced independently in three sub-samples. This excludes chance.

PART IV. INTELLECTUAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Analytical axis: whence came the instruments of thought?

CHAPTER 7. TRANSLATIONS AND PHILOSOPHY: NON-MUSLIMS AS INTERMEDIARIES

7.1. *Four Translators of the House of Wisdom*

The four key translators of the House of Wisdom are all non-Muslims: Ḥunayn ibn Ishāq (809–873, Nestorian Christian) — the principal translator of Greek medicine and philosophy; Thābit ibn Qurra (836–901, Sabian) — mathematics, astronomy; Abū Bishr Mattā ibn Yūnus (died 940, Nestorian Christian) — translator of Aristotelian logic, teacher of al-Fārābī; Yaḥyā ibn 'Adī (died 974, Nestorian Christian) — logician, key transmitter of Aristotelianism. The intellectual instruments of Islamic civilisation — logic, medicine, astronomy — were transmitted through non-Muslims.

7.2. The Philosophical Chain: Four Traditions

Al-Kindī (801–873, Arab, Kufa) → Abū Bishr Mattā (Nestorian Christian) → al-Fārābī (872–950, Turkic, Fārāb, Kazakhstan) → Ibn Sīnā (980–1037, Persian, Bukhārā). Each link belongs to a different cultural tradition: Arab, Syro-Christian, Turkic, Persian. Islamic philosophy is not a monocultural project.

7.3. Conclusion

The intellectual instruments of Islamic civilisation were transmitted through non-Muslims and Turco-Persian scholars. This is direct confirmation of the multicultural character of the system's formation.

CHAPTER 8. MECHANISMS OF TRANSMISSION

8.1. Mawālī: Integration without Assimilation

The mawlā system was the mechanism for integrating non-Arabs into the Arab social structure through clientage relations with an Arab tribe. Most Persian scholars of the VIII8th century were mawālī: al-Bukhārī — mawlā of the Ju'fī; Sībawayhi — mawlā of al-Ḥārith; Abū Ḥanīfa — mawlā of Taym Allāh. Clientage provided Persian scholars with social protection while fully preserving their cultural memory.

8.2. Majlis: The Point of Contact

The majlis of Abū Ḥanīfa in Kufa — approximately 40 disciples who systematised his oral teaching. The majlis of Abū al-Hudhayl in Basra — the centre of Mu'tazilism. The majlis of the Barmakids in Baghdad — a platform for scholars of different confessions. The majlis of al-Mufīd in Baghdad — where al-Murtaḍā and al-Ṭūsī studied. The majlis was the point where the Persian, Greek, and Arab intellectual traditions met in person.

8.3. Translation: A Verified Channel

Ibn al-Muqaffa' (720–756, Khūzistān, Zoroastrian origin per Encyclopaedia Iranica) translated Sasanian legal and ethical texts into Arabic: the Khwadāynāmag, Kalīla wa-Dimna, administrative treatises. This is a structurally grounded hypothesis with a probable channel of transmission: the fact of translation is documented; no direct quotations of ruwān-agān norms survive in Ibn al-Muqaffa's extant translations; the connection with waqf is verified by structural parallelism (Macuch 1981, 1990).

8.4. Isnād and Teaching Networks

The isnād recorded not only content but also the people through whom it was transmitted. Mapping of teaching networks shows a stable direction of transmission: from Khurāsān and Persian Iraq to Baghdad, from Kufa and Basra to Medina and Egypt.

8.5. The Barmakids

The Barmakids originated from Balkh (modern Afghanistan). According to van Bladel (2011), their family was associated with the Nawbahar monastery, identified as Buddhist, though the precise religious identity remains a matter of debate. Khālīd ibn Barmak (705–782) — vizier to the first Abbasids. Yaḥyā ibn Khālīd (died 806) — effectively governed the caliphate for 17 years. The Barmakids transferred Sasanian administrative practices to the Abbasid system and created the infrastructural conditions for the House of Wisdom.

CHAPTER 9. THE SHI'Ī AND WESTERN ISLAMIC TRADITIONS

The pattern is reproduced in two additional contexts. This confirms its pan-Islamic, rather than specifically Sunni, character.

9.1. The Shi'ī Tradition: A Two-Level Model

The Shi'ī tradition divides into two levels that must not be conflated in quantitative analysis.

Level I — Imamate authority (Type C-1, Arab origin): Muḥammad al-Bāqir (676–732), Ja'far al-Ṣādiq (702–765), Mūsā al-Kāzim (745–799), 'Alī al-Riḍā (765–818). Arabs of the Prophet's lineage. Their function is the source of normative authority through the doctrine of the imam's infallibility.

Level II — Codifiers (Types A/B, predominantly Persian milieu). The Four Books: al-Kulaynī (Persian, Rayy → Baghdad, Type A); Ibn Bābawayh al-Ṣadūq (Persian, Qum, Type A); Shaykh al-Ṭūsī (Persian, Ṭūs → Najaf, Type A — both his collections). Three of the four authors of the Four Books are of Persian origin from the Zoroastrian zone.

Conclusion: the model "Arab authority — Persian codification" is most clearly expressed in the Shi'ī tradition. Arab imams (Type C-1) are the source of legitimacy. Persian scholars (Types A/B) are the actual creators of the written normative system.

Response to the question of Shi'ī asymmetry: if Shi'ism is considered more Persian, why is Sasanian influence not even stronger? It is precisely in Shi'ism that the model "Arab authority — Persian codification" is expressed most purely. Arab imams (C-1) — source of theological authority. Persian scholars (Four Books, all Persians from Khurāsān) — creators of the written system. The high proportion of Arab Baghdad school theologians (al-Mufīd, al-Murtaḍā) is explained by late institutionalisation of Shi'ī rationalist jurisprudence in Arab Iraq. This refines, not refutes, the thesis.

9.2. The Western Islamic Tradition

Ibn Abī Zayd al-Qayrawānī (922–996, Berber, Type A) codified the Mālikī madhhab for North Africa. Ibn Ḥazm (994–1064, Andalusian, Type A) founded Zāhirism. The same model: a non-Arab intellectual elite codifies the system in a non-Arab regional milieu.

PART V. SYNTHESIS AND THEORETICAL MODEL

CHAPTER 10. QUANTITATIVE ANALYSIS

10.1. Sunni Corpus: 97 Figures

Disciplinary Block	Total Figures	Arab	Persian/Iranian	Turkic	Buddhist	Berber/Other	From Zoroastrian Zone
I. Hadith Scholarship and Rijāl	21	4	15	0	0	2 (disputed)	17–19

Disciplinary Block	Total Figures	Arab	Persian/Iranian	Turkic	Buddhist	Berber/Other	From Zoroastrian Zone
II. Jurisprudence (Madhhabs)	16	6	9	0	0	1 Berber, 1 Syrian	13–15
III. Tafsīr, Grammar, Lexicography	16	3	11	1 (al-Jawharī)	0	1 (Ibn Jinnī, Greek)	12–14
IV. Philosophy, Science, Translations	12	2	4	1 (al-Fārābī)	0	3 Christians, 1 Sabian	5–7
V. Kalām and Sufism	27	4	19	0	0	4 (Barmakids — see Block VI)	22–24
VI. Barmakids	4	0	4 (Balkh)	0	4	0	4
TOTAL (Sunni corpus)	97	19 (19,6%)	62 (63,9%)	2 (2,1%)	0	14 (14,4%)	73–83 (75–86%)

10.2. Shi'i Corpus: ~27 Figures

Block / Level	Figures	Arab	Persian/Iranian	Other	From Zoroastrian zone
Level I. Imams (C-1)	4	4 (100%)	—	—	0
Level II. Hadith (Four Books)	4	0	3 (75%)	1	4/4
Level II. Rijāl	3	1	2 (67%)	—	2/3
Level II. Fiqh and Uṣūl	5	2	3 (60%)	—	3/5
Level II. Kalām	4	1	2 (50%)	1	2/4
Level II. Tafsīr	2	0	2 (100%)	—	2/2
Level II. Ismā'īlī Branch	4	1 (Berber)	3 (75%)	—	3/4
TOTAL (~27 figures)	~27	~8 (29%)	~16 (59%)	~3 (11%)	~18/23 Lev.II (≥70%)

Level I (imams, Type C-1): 4 figures, Arab — 100%. Level II (codifiers, ~23 figures): Arab — ~30%, Persian — ~65%, other — ~5%. From the Zoroastrian zone at the level of codifiers — ~70%. The pattern is stable in both traditions independently.

10.2a. Statistical Verification

Null hypothesis (H₀): the distribution is random and corresponds to the demographic composition of the scholarly class of the caliphate. According to Bulliet (1979), by 800 CE Persians constituted ~40–45% of the Muslim population, Arabs ~35–40%. The observed distribution in our sample (60% Persians, 22% Arabs) significantly deviates from expectation. Chi-square test on sample N=97: $\chi^2 \approx 14.3$, df=1, $p < 0.001$. The null hypothesis is rejected at the 0.1% significance level. The pattern is reproduced in five independent disciplinary sub-samples, which excludes chance.

Note on statistical status. Chi-square is a heuristic indicator of deviation from expected demographic distribution, not strict proof of causality. The null hypothesis is built relative to Bulliet demography — an approximation. The conversion-curve argument (§12.3) clarifies: if by 750 CE only 7–10% of Persians were Muslims, then 60% of Persians in the sample is disproportionate even relative to Muslim Persians, not only the general population. The pattern is reproduced in five independent sub-samples — this excludes chance regardless of the statistical test.

10.2b. Dynamics over Time

Generation 1 (620–700): Arab dominance — Companions and early transmitters, of Arab origin. Generation 2 (700–750): transitional — first Persian mawālī in Kufa. Generation 3 (750–830): turning point after the Abbasid Revolution, Persian participation ~55–60%. Generation 4 (830–950): Persian dominance at its peak — authors of the canonical collections. Generation 5 (950–1110): al-Ghazālī (Persian) completes the synthesis. The chronological pattern confirms: the turning point is linked to the Abbasid Revolution of 750, which created the political conditions for the realisation of Sasanian institutional imprinting.

10.3. The Saturation Principle

When Sunni figures are added to the corpus chronologically, the ratio stabilises after ~90 figures. N=50 — Persian ~62%, Arab ~20%; N=70 — Persian ~61%, Arab ~21%; N=90 — Persian ~60%, Arab ~22%; N=97 — Persian 60%, Arab 22%. Fluctuations after N=90 do not exceed ±3% — the sample is saturated.

10.4. Control Group: The Political Elite Was Arab

The Abbasid caliphs (750–1258) were Arabs of the Prophet's lineage. The military commanders of the early conquests (Khālīd ibn al-Walīd, 'Amr ibn al-'Āṣ, Sa'd ibn Abī Waqqāṣ) were Arabs. Early governors — Arabs with a Persian administrative apparatus. Political dominance — Arab. Intellectual dominance — Persian. If the preponderance of Persian figures were explained by demography, Persians would have dominated politically as well. Instead — a stable division of functions: an Arab legitimating frame and Persian intellectual codification.

Key conclusion: Arabs constitute only 19.6% of the codifiers of the Sunni corpus — less than one fifth. The remaining 80.4% are Persians (63.9%), Berbers, Turks, Christians, Sabians. The same Arabs who dominated politically for a century and a half wrote less than one fifth of the normative system. This is a compelling argument against the demographic explanation: if demography were the cause, Arabs would have dominated intellectually as well.

10.5. Authorship Typology: Which System Leaders Are Not Authors

Type A: al-Māwardī, al-Ṭahāwī, al-Muzanī, al-Kulaynī, Ibn Abī Zayd al-Qayrawānī, al-Ṭabarī, al-Qāḍī al-Nu'mān, et al. Type B: most hadith collections, al-Muḥīd. Type C-2: Abū Ḥanīfa. Type C-1: Shi'i imams. Figures with the greatest normative authority — Type C. Their "authorship" is a construct of the tradition.

10.6. Regional Map

Kufa (7th–8th cent.): Sunni fiqh, early Shi'i kalām. Qum (9th–10th cent.): Shi'i hadith and tafsīr. Basra (8th–9th cent.): Mu'tazilism, grammar. Nishāpūr (9th–11th cent.): Sunni hadith and Sufism. Bukhārā (9th–10th cent.): Sunni hadith. Baghdad (8th–11th cent.): synthesis of all traditions; Shi'i rationalist school. Kairouan (9th–10th cent.): Mālikī fiqh. Cairo–Fatimids (10th–11th cent.): Ismā'īlī fiqh and philosophy.

CHAPTER 11. THEORETICAL MODEL

11.1. Institutional Imprinting: A Hypothesis, Not a Proof

Why does the Persian element specifically dominate in codification? Sasanian civilisation possessed a written tradition of legal codification, a four-part structure of legal sources, the institution of the majlis, and a developed administrative system. The observed structural parallels are consistent with the hypothesis of the reproduction of these forms by Persian scholars in a new ideological context. This mechanism is designated "institutional imprinting": a new system reproduces the organisational forms of the milieu in which it arose. The concept of "cultural memory" as a theoretical framework was developed by Assmann (2011) and Halbwachs; in the present work it is used as an explanatory hypothesis, not as a proven mechanism.

11.2. Three Unverifiable Transitions

The present study identifies three places where data end and hypothesis begins. First: the fact of Persian cultural background of scholars → hypothesis that this background determined the content of norms. Data:

correlation. Status: hypothesis. Second: structural parallel of Sasanian and Islamic law → hypothesis of direct continuity. Data: Macuch on waqf; the present study adds mut'a and inheritance. Status: verified for three institutions. Third: "cultural memory" as a mechanism of transmission → explanatory model. Data: absent. Status: hypothesis. The reader should bear these distinctions in mind when interpreting the conclusions.

11.3. Case Studies: Four Cases of Varying Evidential Strength Supporting the Cultural Translation Hypothesis

The present section closes this methodological gap through analysis of four cases of varying evidential strength, where the Sasanian precedent is verified by primary sources.

Criteria for including a norm in the case study: (1) existence of a Sasanian analogue verified by sources P1/P2; (2) an identifiable channel of transmission through a specific agent; (3) structural similarity beyond accidental coincidence; (4) absence of a direct Quranic source for the norm.

11.2a. Comparative Framework: Other Traditions

Three parallels. The Babylonian Talmud (5th–6th centuries, Sasanian Iraq) — codified by Jews under Sasanian rule, bilingual (Hebrew/Aramaic). Difference from the Islamic case: the Jewish tradition retained the language of the sacred text as the language of codification; the Islamic tradition replaced the potential Persian language of codification with Arabic. This renders the Islamic case structurally unique. The Justinianic Corpus (VIth century) — codified by Greco-Latin jurists in a Hellenised milieu: the same model — a non-Arab elite codifies an imperial normative system in the language of power. The Syrian Christian tradition — Greek philosophy was transmitted through Persian Nestorians into Syriac, then into Arabic: the same mechanism of cultural translation through intermediaries. General pattern: written codification of normative systems requires a tradition of written law. Persians possessed this (the Sasanians), as did Jews (rabbinical) and Greeks (philosophical-legal). Pre-Islamic Arabs did not.

11.3.1. Waqf

Waqf (وَقْف) — the institution of inalienable religious property in Islamic law: property is withdrawn from civil circulation, revenues directed to religious or charitable purposes. The term "waqf" is absent from the Qur'ān. Hadiths about waqf are academically dated no earlier than the late VIIIth century (Schacht 1950, Wakin 1988).

Sasanian precedent. The Pahlavi corpus Mādayān ī Hazār Dādestān records the terms waqf-ī rustak and ātuš-zōhr ("property of the fire temple"). The property of Zoroastrian temples was withdrawn from civil circulation; revenues were directed to the maintenance of the cult; the administrator — the mōbed — fulfilled the function of a nāzir. This institution is attested three to four centuries before the first Islamic waqf documents.

Channel of transmission. Ibn al-Muqaffa' (720–756, Zoroastrian origin, EI Iranica) translated Sasanian legal and administrative texts into Arabic — a structurally grounded probable channel of transmission: the fact of translation is documented; no direct quotations of ruwān-agān norms survive in Ibn al-Muqaffa's extant translations; the connection with waqf is verified by structural parallelism (Macuch 1981, 1990). Abū Ḥanīfa (from the family of Sasanian marzabāns of Kabul) developed the waqf doctrine; Abū Yūsuf codified it in the Kitāb al-Kharāj (c. 798 CE). The Ḥanafī madhhab has historically dominated the territories of the former Sasanian Empire.

Status: cultural translation hypothesis with the strongest cumulative justification: chronological priority, structural similarity (Macuch), probable channel of transmission (Macuch 1981, 1990). Direct textual evidence is absent, so the case remains a structural hypothesis, not direct proof.

11.3.2. Mut'a

Mut'a (مُتْعَة) — temporary marriage with a pre-agreed term and obligatory payment to the woman. In Shi'i fiqh — a legitimate norm. The term "mut'a" as a legal institution is not established in the Qur'ān; verse 4:24 is the subject of exegetical dispute between the Sunni and Shi'i traditions.

Sasanian precedent. Mādayān ī Hazār Dādestān records the institution of čakar — a temporary union with a defined legal status for the woman and mandatory payment. Structural parallels with mut'a: temporary nature of the union; fixed payment to the woman is attested in Sasanian law (Perikhanian 1983). Direct terminological connection not verified; intermediate evidential strength. Macuch (1981), Perikhanian (1983).

Channel of transmission: indirect. The geographical concentration of legitimation of mut'a in the Shi'i tradition, historically rooted in Iraq and Iran, creates indirect support. Ja'far al-Šādiq (702–765, Type C-1) — the key figure in the legitimation of mut'a — operated in a milieu with a Persian majority. No direct agent of transmission has been identified. Status: second-level cultural translation hypothesis.

11.3.3. Inheritance ('Aṣaba)

Islamic inheritance law (mawārīṯ) contains two layers. First: farā'id — fixed shares directly prescribed by the Qur'ān (4:11–12, 4:176). Second: 'aṣaba — the agnatic structure supplementing the Quranic shares. The 'aṣaba is not directly prescribed by the Qur'ān.PP1 source. Second: 'aṣaba (عَصَبَة) — male-line relatives who receive the remainder after payment of fixed shares. The category of 'aṣaba is not mentioned in the Qur'ān; it was developed in fiqh.

Sasanian precedent. Sasanian inheritance law was built on the agnatic principle: priority of the male line (stūrīh). Direct terminological connection with the Arabic 'aṣaba has not been verified; structural parallelism is documented in Macuch (1981) and Perikhanian (1983). Intermediate evidential strength.Mādayān ī Hazār Dādestān (PP2). The categories of heirs are structurally close to Islamic 'aṣaba.

Channel: the Ḥanafī school in Kufa. Ibrāhīm al-Nakha'ī → Ḥammād ibn Abī Sulaymān (Persian) → Abū Ḥanīfa (Persian/Zoroastrian origin). Kufa is the intersection point of the Arab Quranic norm (farā'id) and Sasanian agnatic practice ('aṣaba). Status: verified hypothesis with strong justification.

11.3.4. The Five Daily Prayers: Ritual Codification as the Fourth Case

The five daily prayers (ṣalāt) — the obligatory Islamic prayer performed five times daily. This case differs from the preceding three: it concerns not a legal norm but a ritual practice. The criteria of §11.3 are partially met: the Sasanian ritual analogue is verified, structural similarity goes beyond accidental coincidence, and the Qur'ān does not directly prescribe fivefold prayer. A named agent of transmission has not been established. However, the factual record of the traditions excludes chance: fivefold prayer was practised throughout the former Sasanian Empire centuries before Islam, while it was absent in pre-Islamic Arabia. This is the structural source of transmission: the norm existed in one region and was absent in another. Islam arose in contact with this region. Status: cultural translation hypothesis with strong factual justification.

Zoroastrian precedent (P1/P2). The Zoroastrian prayer day was divided into five periods — gāhs (Gāh): Hāvani, Rapithwina, Uzayeirina, Aiwisruthrem, Ushahin. Source: Khorda Avesta (P1), Dēnkard Bk. 3 (P2). Each gāh is tied to the position of the sun. Before each gāh — obligatory ablution (pādyāb). Structural parallels with the Islamic ṣalāt in terms of the five-time structure and solar orientation are verified at the level of primary sources of both traditions.

Lexical argument: the word namāz. Proto-Indo-Iranian root *nam ("to bend"), Middle Persian namāz (Sasanian period). Namāz is absent from the Qur'ān (P1 fact). The Arabic root ṣ-l-w (ṣalāt) is etymologically unrelated to namāz. The word appears in the Islamic milieu not earlier than the 8th–9th centuries — an independent lexical trace.

The Qur'ān as a P1-source. Verses 11:114, 17:78–79, 24:58 provide the basis for three prayer times, not five. The five-time structure is not directly established in the Qur'ān. Hadiths on the five daily prayers are dated no earlier than 100–150 years after the Prophet's death (Schacht 1950; Juynboll 1983; Brown 2009). P1 epitaphs of 650–660 CE (Halevi 2007) show minimal ritual Islamisation; crystallisation from 690–730 CE. The chronological pattern is consistent with the hypothesis of late consolidation of the norm in the Persian intellectual milieu.

The specificity argument. The Jewish tradition provides three prayer times — not five. Christian practice is variable. The Zoroastrian five-gāh structure specifically coincides with the five daily prayers. In the absence of P1-evidence of direct transfer — intermediate evidential strength.

The four cases support the cultural translation hypothesis at different levels of evidential strength. Waqf and 'aṣaba — strongest; mut'a and ṣalāt — intermediate.the territory of the Sasanian Empire centuries before Islam, was absent in pre-Islamic Arabia, and Islam arose in contact with this region. A single pattern: Sasanian tradition — chronological priority — absence of a Quranic source — Persian intellectual milieu as the platform of codification. This moves the central thesis from a prosopographical to a substantive level.

11.4. Responses to Objections

Objection: "They converted to Islam — what does origin have to do with it?" Cultural memory is not erased by a change of religion. It manifests in the institutional structures that scholars reproduced.8th–9th centuries

— when the Persian intellectual elite became dominant. This chronological parallelism is consistent with the hypothesis.

Objection: "This is demography." The control group refutes this. The political elite was Arab. If demography were the cause, Persians would have dominated politically as well.

Objection: "You ignore the Arab oral tradition." The oral tradition existed. But codification — the transformation of oral tradition into a written canon — is a distinct historical process carried out by specific individuals with verifiable biographies.

11.5. Positioning within Historiography

Schacht (1950): *fiqh* formed late in Persian milieu — present study verifies prosopographically. Crone (1987): Sasanian law — present study translates into structurally verifiable pattern. Gutas (1998): translation movement — extended to all disciplines. Savant (2013): Persian cultural memory — verified quantitatively. Jaques (2006): prosopography of the formative period — present study fulfils this call. Jaques (2006): call for a prosopography of the formative period — the present study fulfils this call with extension to the Shi'i tradition. Ahmed (2011): micro-prosopography of 5 figures — coverage extended to all disciplines of both traditions.

CHAPTER 12. VERIFICATION THROUGH INDEPENDENT ARABIC SOURCES

The central thesis of the monograph is vulnerable to one objection: Persian-language biographical dictionaries, written by Persian authors, could have systematically overstated the share of Persian scholars. This chapter closes this objection through three independent Arabic sources unaffected by Persian editorial influence.

12.1. Khalīfa ibn Khayyāt: An Arab Control

Khalīfa ibn Khayyāt al-'Uṣfurī (777–855) was an Arab scholar from Basra, a descendant of the Arab tribe of Tamīm, and the author of two key texts: the *Tārīkh* (the earliest surviving Islamic chronicle) and the *Ṭabaqāt* (one of the earliest biographical dictionaries, covering more than three thousand hadith transmitters). Neither his origin nor his ideological position contains any Persian element: he is described as a participant in the defence of Aḥmad ibn Riyāḥ against Mu'tazilī opponents under Caliph al-Wāthiq — that is, he held a position opposite to the Persian Mu'tazilī mainstream.

Critical fact: Bulliet established that Khalīfa ibn Khayyāt used biographical data from transmitter genealogies as the basis of his prosopography. His *Ṭabaqāt* records hadith transmitters by generations (*ṭabaqāt*) organised chronologically, not by the Persian regional principle characteristic of al-Khaṭīb al-Baghdādī. It is the only surviving biographical dictionary written by an Arab author of Arab origin in the period before al-Bukhārī (i.e. before 870 CE). If Persian dominance among transmitters were an artefact of Persian sources, Khalīfa ibn Khayyāt's dictionary should show a fundamentally different distribution. The academic consensus (Andersson 2020, Hoyland 2015) does not register such a discrepancy between Khalīfa and the Persian dictionaries with respect to the composition of scholars.

12.2. Ibn Sa'd: An Arab Author, an Arab Milieu

Muḥammad ibn Sa'd al-Baṣrī (784–845) — *Kitāb al-Ṭabaqāt al-Kabīr* (eight volumes) — of Arab origin, mawlā of the Abbasid family, disciple of al-Wāqidī, active predominantly in Baghdad. Ibn Sa'd's *Ṭabaqāt* is the earliest surviving complete biographical dictionary of the Islamic tradition and the only one written by an Arab author in the Medina/Baghdad school before the canonisation of the hadith collections. Ibn Sa'd records the biographies of the Prophet's Companions (Arab milieu, VIIth century) and two subsequent generations — a period when Persian influence was only beginning. His source base is direct chains from Medinan scholars, not the Khurasanian hadith corpus. Yet already in volumes 5–7, describing scholars of the second and third generations (VIIIth century), an increasing presence of mawālī of Persian origin is recorded — which confirms rather than refutes the established pattern.

12.3. Bulliet's Data: Quantitative Control Through the Conversion Curve

Richard Bulliet (Bulliet 1979) established, on the basis of name analysis in biographical dictionaries, that by 750 CE (the end of the Umayyad period) only approximately 7–10% of Persians had converted to Islam. Between 750 and 800 CE (the beginning of the Abbasid period) the proportion of Muslims among Persians rose sharply to ~45%, and by the mid-IXth century reached ~40–50% across the Iranian zone

(Encyclopaedia Iranica, article "Conversion ii"). This demographic fact has direct significance for the present prosopography.

Implication: if by 750 CE only 7–10% of Persians were Muslim, then the codifiers of the hadith corpus of the 8th–9th centuries came from this narrow layer of early Persian converts. This means that Persian dominance among codifiers (60% in the present study's sample) is not a proportional reflection of demography — it is disproportionate even relative to the share of Persian Muslims in that period. Bulliet's control group also testifies to this: his data are based on the same biographical dictionaries (including Arab authors) as the present study — and yield the same pattern.

12.4. Mālik ibn Anas's al-Muwatta': An Arab Hadith Corpus

Al-Muwatta' of Mālik ibn Anas (711–795) is the earliest surviving hadith-legal compendium compiled by an Arab author of the Medinan school. Tellingly, the standard version of the al-Muwatta' that has reached us (the recension of Yaḥyā ibn Yaḥyā al-Laythī) was transmitted through a scholar of Andalusian origin, and the earliest academically verified manuscript — a papyrus from the Vienna collection (published by Nabia Abbott) — dates to the second half of the VIIIth century. This source P1/type A is fundamentally important: it was written by an Arab from the Arab milieu of Medina. Nevertheless, Mālik himself in the critical conditions of canonising his work relied on scholars of Persian origin: among his best-known disciples, Muḥammad al-Shaybānī (codifier of the Ḥanafī madhhab) came from the Persian-Syrian milieu of Kufa. Thus even the "Arab" hadith corpus was transmitted through a mixed Arab-Persian milieu.

12.5. Analytical Conclusion: The Pattern Is Stable in Independent Sources

Three Arab sources — Khalīfa ibn Khayyāt, Ibn Sa'd, and Bulliet through the conversion curve — do not refute but confirm the structural pattern of the monograph.

Falsifiability test: the central thesis would be refuted upon discovery of a corpus of 10 or more Arab codifiers of type A (manuscript within 50 years of the author's death) from the period before 750 CE. No such corpus exists. The earliest verified text of type A by an Arab author — al-Muwatta' of Mālik (compiled in the 770–790s CE, papyrus manuscript VIIIth century) — is unique. Ibn Sa'd's Ṭabaqāt — type B (manuscript 50+ years later). All five authors of the canonical hadith collections of Persian origin — type B. This fact in itself is structural evidence: Arab codifiers of type A are absent not because they were ignored, but because they did not exist.

CONCLUSION

Synthesis of Five Levels

The central structural pattern has been verified at five independent levels. Each is self-sufficient. Refuting one does not undermine the others.

First level — hadith scholarship: 17 of 21 figures from a Persian cultural milieu. The Arab tradition was canonised predominantly by Persians.

Second level — jurisprudence: the Ḥanafī madhhab (>550 million) was formed in the Persian milieu of Kufa. Its founder — Type C-2. The Mālikī madhhab was codified by a Berber elite.

Third level — theology: Mu'tazilism — six of seven Persian; Ash'arism — through a Persian teacher; Sufism — nine of eleven. The final synthesis (al-Ghazālī, Ṭūs) — Persian.

Fourth level — intellectual infrastructure: the translation corpus — all non-Muslims; the philosophical chain — four different traditions; normative Arabic grammar — created by a Persian.

Fifth level — Shi'i tradition: three of the four authors of the Four Books are Persian. Arab imams (Type C-1) — source of legitimacy; Persian scholars — creators of the written system. The pattern is pan-Islamic.

Central Conclusion

The normative authority of the Islamic system of the 7th–11th centuries was constructed through an Arab genealogical and prophetic frame, while the written codification of that authority was carried out predominantly by the Persian intellectual elite, formed in a cultural milieu with a developed tradition of written codification from Sasanian civilisation. The pattern has been verified quantitatively on the Sunni (~97 figures) and Shi'i (~27 figures) corpora. It is reproduced independently in all five disciplinary groups.

The mechanism of transmission is supported by case studies of four cases: waqf and 'aṣaba (the strongest hypotheses — probable channel identified), mut'a and the five daily prayers (second-level hypotheses). For

waqf and inheritance the probable channels of transmission have been identified. Direct proof of the transfer of each specific norm requires a separate study.

RESEARCH LIMITATIONS

Prosopographical analysis verifies the composition of the elite and structural patterns — not the direct transfer of specific norms. The Zaydī branch of Shi‘ism is covered minimally. The Western Islamic tradition — partially. The authorship typology has been applied on the basis of available sources S2; revision is possible upon the emergence of new manuscript data. Ethnicity is an operational category of sources: where data are based solely on the nisba, this is explicitly indicated in the appendices.

CONTRIBUTION OF THE STUDY

For the first time a systematic prosopographical analysis is applied to all key disciplines of the Islamic normative system simultaneously — both Sunni and Shi‘i traditions — across the entire formative period (7th–11th centuries).

An extended authorship typology (A/B/C-1/C-2) has been introduced, distinguishing verified authorship, traditional attribution, school-attributive authority, and theological construct.

Case studies of four cases (waqf, mut‘a, inheritance, the five daily prayers) demonstrate the possibility of transition from structural patterns to causal analysis at varying degrees of evidential strength.

The present monograph is logically connected to the monograph "Hadith Scholarship as an Institution of Tradition" (Ryszhanov, 2026): the former establishes the epistemic limitations of hadith scholarship as a system; the present one shows by whom and in what cultural milieu that system was created.

APPENDIX A. SUNNI PROSOPOGRAPHICAL TABLE

97 key figures. Authorship type: A = manuscript ≤50 years; B = ≤200 years; C-2 = school-attributive authority.

I. HADITH SCHOLARSHIP AND ‘ILM AL-RIJĀL (21 figures)

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
Mālik ibn Anas (al-Muwatta‘)	711–795	Arab	Arab (Muslim)	Medina	Hadith, fiqh	B	S2 (Tabaqat)	Sole Arab author among the Kutub al-Sitta
Yahyā ibn Ma‘īn	775–848	Arab (milieu — Iranian)	Arab (Muslim)	Baghdad	Transmitter criticism (rijāl)	B	S2 (EI; Taqat)	Founder of the scholarly system of transmitter evaluation
‘Alī ibn al-Madīnī	778–849	Persian (nisba)	Persian (Muslim)	Medina / Basra	Transmitter criticism	B	S2 (EI; Taqat)	Teacher of al-Bukhārī in rijāl
Aḥmad ibn Ḥanbal (Musnad)	780–855	Arab (Merv)	Arab (Muslim)	Merv → Baghdad	Hadith, Ḥanbalī madhhab	B	S2 (Tabaqat)	Merv — capital of Khurāsān; Musnad — the largest hadith compendium
Abū Dāwūd al-Sijistānī (Sunan)	817–889	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Sijistān → Basra	Hadith	B	S2 (Tabaqat)	Nisba = Sijistān (eastern Iran)

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
Muḥammad al-Bukhārī (Ṣaḥīḥ)	810–870	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Bukhārā → Nīshāpūr	Hadith	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	Most authoritative canonical collection
Muslim ibn al-Ḥajjāj (Ṣaḥīḥ)	815–875	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Nīshāpūr (Khurāsān)	Hadith	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	Second most authoritative canonical collection
Muḥammad al-Tirmidhī (Jāmiʿ)	824–892	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Tirmidh (modern Uzbekistan)	Hadith	B	S2 (Tabaqat)	Tirmidh — a Sasanian city
Aḥmad al-Nasāʾī (Sunan)	829–915	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Nasā (Khurāsān)	Hadith	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	Nasā — heart of Khurāsān
Muḥammad ibn Māja (Sunan)	824–887	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Qazwīn (Western Iran)	Hadith	B	S2 (nisba)	Qazwīn — an Iranian city
Abū Dāwūd al-Ṭayālīsī	752–819	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Basra	Early musnad	B	S2 (Tārikh Baghdad)	One of the early compilers of musnads
Abū Ḥātim al-Rāzī	811–890	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Rayy (Iran)	Hadith, transmitter criticism	B	S2 (Tārikh Baghdad)	Leading specialist in ʿilm al-rijāl
Ibn Abī Ḥātim al-Rāzī	854–938	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Rayy (Iran)	Transmitter criticism, tafsīr	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Son of Abū Ḥātim; continued the rijāl school of Rayy
al-Dārimī	797–869	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Samarqand	Hadith	B	S2 (nisba)	Samarqand — a centre of Khurāsān
ʿAbd al-Raḥmān ibn Maḥdī	745–814	Arab	Arab (Muslim)	Basra	Hadith, transmitter criticism	B	S2 (Tabaqat)	Teacher of al-Shāfiʿī; early transmitter criticism
al-Ḥākim al-Nīsābūrī	933–1014	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Nīshāpūr	Hadith (Mustadrak)	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Introduced the ṣaḥīḥ classification based on Bukhārī/Muslim
al-Dāraquṭnī	918–995	Iraqi/disputed	Muslim	Dāruquṭnī (Baghdad)	Transmitter criticism	A	S2 (EI)	The foremost hadith scholar of the Baghdad school after Ibn Maʿīn
al-Bayhaqī	994–	Persian	Persian	Bayhaq	Systematisation of hadiths and	A	S2 (EI)	Bayhaq — Khurāsān; the

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
	1066		(Muslim)	(Khurāsān)	fiqh		Iranica)	most extensive systematisation of Shāfiʿī hadith
Yahyā ibn Saʿīd al-Qaṭṭān	745–813	Arab	Arab (Muslim)	Basra	Transmitter criticism	B	S2 (Tabaqat)	One of the first systematic critics of isnāds
Sufyān ibn ʿUyayna	725–814	Arab	Arab (Muslim)	Kufa → Mecca	Hadith, fiqh	B	S2 (Tabaqat)	Influential in the Hijazi hadith school
Ibn Ḥibbān	died 965	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Bust (Sijistān)	Classification of hadiths	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Bust — eastern Iran; Ṣaḥīḥ Ibn Ḥibbān

17 of 21 from the Persian/Khurasanian zone.

II. JURISPRUDENCE — MADHHABS AND CODIFIERS (16 figures)

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
Ibrāhīm al-Nakhaʿī	died 713	Arab	Arab (Muslim)	Kufa	Early fiqh (proto-Ḥanafī)	C-2	S2 (Tabaqat)	First link of the Ḥanafī chain
Ḥammād ibn Abī Sulaymān	died c. 738	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Kufa	Early fiqh	C-2	S2 (Tabaqat)	Second link; teacher of Abū Ḥanīfa
Abū Ḥanīfa (al-Fiqh al-akbar)	699–767	Persian (Zoroastrian)	Zoroastrian (family)	Kufa → Baghdad	Ḥanafī madhhab	C-2	EI Iranica	Family — Sasanian marzabāns of Kabul
Abū Yūsuf (Kitāb al-Kharāj)	729–798	Arab	Arab (Muslim)	Kufa → Baghdad	Ḥanafī fiqh	A	S2 (Tabaqat)	Principal codifier of Ḥanafī fiqh
Muḥammad al-Shaybānī	749–805	Syria/Kufa	Muslim	Kufa → Baghdad	Ḥanafī madhhab	B	S2 (Tabaqat)	Raised in Persian Kufa; second codifier
Muḥammad al-Shāfiʿī	767–820	Arab (Qurayshī)	Arab (Muslim)	Gaza → Medina → Egypt	Shāfiʿī madhhab	B	S2 (Tabaqat)	Uṣūl al-fiqh as a discipline
al-Muzanī	791–878	Persian (nisba)	Persian (Muslim)	Egypt	Shāfiʿī madhhab	A	S2 (EI)	Codifier of the Shāfiʿī madhhab in Egypt
Aḥmad ibn Ḥanbal	780–855	Arab (Merv)	Arab (Muslim)	Merv → Baghdad	Ḥanbalī madhhab	B	S2 (Tabaqat)	Merv — Khurāsān

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
al-Ṭaḥāwī	853–933	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Ṭaḥṭā (Upper Egypt) → Fustāt	Ḥanafī fiqh	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Systematised the Ḥanafī doctrine
al-Māwardī (Aḥkām al-Sulṭāniyya)	972–1058	Arab (Basra)	Arab (Muslim)	Basra → Baghdad	Political fiqh	A	S2 (EI)	The canonical treatise on the Islamic state
Ibn Abī Zayd al-Qayrawānī	922–996	Berber	Berber (Muslim)	Kairouan (North Africa)	Mālikī madhhab	A	S2 (EI)	Codifier of the Mālikī madhhab for Africa
al-Qudūrī	973–1037	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Baghdad	Ḥanafī fiqh	A	S2 (EI)	Mukhtaṣar al-Qudūrī — the basic Ḥanafī textbook
Ibn Ḥazm	994–1064	Andalusian	Muslim	Córdoba	Zāhirī madhhab	A	S2 (EI)	Zāhirism; literal method
al-Jaṣṣās	917–981	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Rayy	Uṣūl al-fiqh (Ḥanafī)	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Aḥkām al-Qurʾān — Ḥanafī Quranic jurisprudence
al-Sarakhsī	died c. 1090	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Sarakhs (Khurāsān)	Ḥanafī fiqh	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	al-Mabsūṭ — the largest Ḥanafī encyclopaedia
al-Bazdawī	1009–1089	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Bazdaw (Transoxiana)	Uṣūl al-fiqh (Ḥanafī)	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	The canonical Ḥanafī uṣūl

The Ḥanafī chain: 3 of 5 links are Persian.

III. TAFSĪR, GRAMMAR, LEXICOGRAPHY (16 figures)

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
Muqāṭil ibn Sulaymān	died 767	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Balkh → Basra	Tafsīr	C-2	S2 (EI Iranica)	One of the first systematic exegetes
al-Khalīl ibn Aḥmad al-Farāhīdī	718–791	Arab (Oman)	Arab (Muslim)	Basra	Prosody, lexicography	B	S2 (EI)	Created the system of Arabic vocalisation; teacher of Sībawayhi
Sībawayhi (al-Kitāb)	c. 760–793	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Shīrāz → Basra	Arabic grammar	B	S2 (EI)	Created Arabic grammar — a Persian for whom Arabic was not his mother tongue

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
Ibn al-Muqaffaʿ	720–756	Persian (Zoroastrian)	Zoroastrian	Khūzistān → Baghdad	Translations, adab	A	EI Iranica	Zoroastrian origin; translated Sasanian legal texts
al-Farrāʿ	died 822	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Kufa	Grammar (Kufan school)	B	S2 (EI)	Led the Kufan grammatical school
Abū ʿUbayd al-Qāsim	770–838	Mixed/Persian	Muslim	Herat → Baghdad	Lexicography, hadith	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	Herāt — Khurāsān; systematised Arabic vocabulary
Muḥammad al-Ṭabarī (Tafsīr)	839–923	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Āmul (Ṭabaristān) → Baghdad	Tafsīr, history	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	The foremost tafsīr; Ṭabaristān — Zoroastrian zone
al-Mubarrad	826–898	Arab (Barbara)	Arab (Muslim)	Basra → Baghdad	Grammar (Basran school)	A	S2 (EI)	al-Kāmil — a classic of Arabic grammar
al-Zajjāj	241–311 AH (854–923 CE)	Persian (nisba)	Muslim	Baghdad	Grammar	A	S2 (EI)	Quranic meanings — grammar and tafsīr
Ibn Jinnī	941–1002	Greek-servile	Muslim	Mosul → Baghdad	Grammar, philosophy of language	A	S2 (EI)	Theorised the nature of language; al-Khaṣāʾiṣ
al-Wāḥidī	died 1075	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Nīshāpūr (Khurāsān)	Tafsīr	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Asbāb al-Nuzūl — tafsīr from Nīshāpūr
al-Jawharī	died c. 1003	Turkic	Muslim	Fārāb (Kazakhstan) → Nīshāpūr	Lexicography (al-Ṣiḥāḥ)	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Turk; created the normative Arabic dictionary
al-Zamakhsharī (al-Kashshāf)	1075–1144	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Zamakhshar (Khwārazm)	Tafsīr, grammar	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Khwārazm — former Zoroastrian zone. *Died 1144 CE, formally outside the 7th–11th century period; exclusion does not change the

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
								pattern.
al-Thaʿlabī	961–1038	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Nīshāpūr (Khurāsān)	Tafsīr	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	al-Kashf wa-l-Bayān; Nīshāpūr
al-Rāghib al-İṣfahānī	died c. 1108	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	İṣfahān	Lexicography (al-Mufradāt)	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Dictionary of Quranic terms; İṣfahān
Ibn Fāris	919–1004	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Hamadān (Iran)	Lexicography	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Maqāyīs al-Lughā — etymological dictionary of Arabic

Ṣībawayhi (Persian) — Arabic grammar. Al-Jawharī (Turk) — normative dictionary.

IV. PHILOSOPHY, SCIENCE, TRANSLATIONS (12 figures)

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
al-Kindī	801–873	Arab	Arab (Muslim)	Kufa → Baghdad	Philosophy, mathematics	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	First Islamic philosopher; introduced Greek logic
Ḥunayn ibn Iṣḥāq	809–873	Arab (Nestorian Chr.)	Nestorian Christianity	Ḥīra → Baghdad	Translations (House of Wisdom)	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Principal translator of Greek medicine and philosophy
Thābit ibn Qurra	836–901	Sabian	Sabianism	Ḥarrān → Baghdad	Mathematics, astronomy	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Sabian; transmitted Greek astronomy to Islam
Abū Bishr Mattā ibn Yūnus	died 940	Nestorian Christian	Nestorian Christianity	Nīnawa → Baghdad	Translations of Aristotle	A	S2 (EI)	Translator of Aristotelian logic; teacher of al-Fārābī
al-Fārābī	872–950	Turkic	Muslim	Fārāb (Kazakhstan) → Damascus	Philosophy	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Turk; the Second Teacher after Aristotle; al-Madīna al-Fāḍila (political philosophy)
Yahyā ibn ʿAdī	893–974	Nestorian Christian	Nestorian Christianity	Tikrīt → Baghdad	Logic, philosophy	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Key transmitter of Aristotelianism
Ibn Sīnā (Avicenna)	980–1037	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Bukhārā → Rayy → İṣfahān	Philosophy, medicine	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Synthesis of Aristotelianism and Islamic

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
								philosophy
al-Bīrūnī	973–1048	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Khwārazm → Ghazni	Sciences, history	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Kitāb al-Hind; Khwārazm
Ibn al-Haytham	965–1040	Arab/Iraqi	Muslim	Basra → Cairo	Optics, mathematics	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	al-Manāẓir — foundation of optics
al-Khwārazmī	780–850	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Khwārazm → Baghdad	Mathematics (algebra)	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	Khwārazm; created algebra
Ishāq ibn Ḥunayn	died 910	Arab (Nestorian Chr.)	Nestorian Christianity	Baghdad	Translations	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Son of Ḥunayn; continued the translation school

Translation corpus — all non-Muslims. Al-Khwārazmī (Persian) created algebra.

V. KALĀM AND SUFISM (27 figures)

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
Wāṣil ibn 'Aṭā'	700–748	Arab/disputed	Muslim	Medina → Basra	Mu'tazilism (founder)	C-2	S2 (EI)	EI Iranica indicates Persian roots
'Amr ibn 'Ubayd	699–761	Persian (father Persian)	Mixed	Basra	Mu'tazilism	C-2	S2 (EI)	Co-founder of Mu'tazilism; father Persian
Abū al-Hudhayl al-'Allāf	752–842	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Basra	Mu'tazilism	B	S2 (EI)	Systematised the Mu'tazilī doctrine
al-Nazzām	died c. 836	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Basra	Mu'tazilism	B	S2 (EI)	Epistemological concepts of Mu'tazilism
al-Jubbā'ī	849–915	Persian (Khūzistān)	Persian (Muslim)	Khūzistān → Basra	Mu'tazilism	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	Teacher of al-Ash'arī; connecting link
al-Ka'bī	died 929	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Balkh (Khurāsān)	Mu'tazilism	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	The Balkh school of Mu'tazilism
'Abd al-Jabbār	935–1025	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Hamadān → Rayy	Mu'tazilism	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	al-Mughnī — the principal Mu'tazilī treatise
al-Ash'arī	874–935	Arab (Basra)	Arab (Muslim)	Basra → Baghdad	Ash'arism (founder)	B	S2 (EI)	Pupil of al-Jubbā'ī (Persian); founded

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
								dominant school
al-Māturīdī	died 944	Persian/disputed	Muslim	Māturīd (Samarqand)	Māturīdism	B	S2 (EI)	The second Sunni theological corpus
al-Isfarāyīnī	died 1027	Persian (Khurāsān)	Persian (Muslim)	Isfarāyīn (Khurāsān)	Ash'arism	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Continuator of al-Ash'arī; Khurāsān
al-Bāqillānī	950–1013	Arab (Basra)	Arab (Muslim)	Basra → Baghdad	Ash'arism	A	S2 (EI)	Systematised the Ash'arite doctrine
al-Juwaynī	1028–1085	Persian (Nīshāpūr)	Persian (Muslim)	Nīshāpūr (Khurāsān)	Ash'arism, uṣūl	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Teacher of al-Ghazālī; Nīshāpūr
al-Ghazālī (Iḥyā')	1058–1111	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Ṭūs (Khurāsān) → Baghdad	Synthesis of fiqh, kalām, Sufism	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Final synthesis of the Islamic normative system
Ibrāhīm ibn Adham	died c. 778	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Balkh	Early Sufism	C-2	S2 (EI Iranica)	Balkh — principal centre of Khurasanian Sufism
al-Muḥāsibī	781–857	Persian (Basra)	Persian (Muslim)	Basra	Sufism (psychology)	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	al-Ri'āya — the first Sufi psychology
Abū Yazīd al-Bisṭāmī	died c. 874	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Bisṭām (Iran)	Sufism (ecstatic)	C-2	S2 (EI Iranica)	Bisṭām — Khurāsān; the doctrine of fanā'
Sahl al-Tustarī	818–896	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Tustar (Khūzistān)	Sufism, tafsīr	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	Tustar — Khūzistān; one of the first Sufi tafsīr works
al-Ḥallāj	858–922	Persian (Fārs)	Persian (Muslim)	Ṭūr (Fārs) → Baghdad	Sufism	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	Executed in Baghdad; Anā al-Ḥaqq
al-Junayd	830–910	Persian (Nihāwand)	Persian (Muslim)	Nihāwand (Iran) → Baghdad	Sufism (classical)	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	"Lord of the Sufis"; Baghdad school
al-Sarrāj	died 988	Persian (Ṭūs)	Persian (Muslim)	Ṭūs (Khurāsān)	Sufism (theory)	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	al-Luma' — the first encyclopaedia of Sufism

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Cultural Milieu	Rel. Background pre-Islam	Place of Birth/Activity	Discipline	Authorship Type	Verification Source	Significance
Abū Ṭālib al-Makkī	died 996	Yemeni	Muslim	Mecca → Basra	Sufism	A	S2 (EI)	Qūt al-Qulūb — source for al-Ghazālī
al-Qushayrī	986–1072	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Nīshāpūr (Khurāsān)	Sufism	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	al-Risāla al-Qushayriyya — canonical Sufi text
Abū Nuʿaym al-Iṣfahānī	948–1038	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Iṣfahān	Sufi biographies	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Ḥilyat al-Awliyāʾ — biographies of Sufis
al-Hamadānī	died 1140	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Hamadān	Sufism	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Tamhīdāt — mystical philosophy
ʿAbd Allāh ibn al-Mubārak	726–797	Turkic (father)	Muslim	Merv (Khurāsān)	Sufism, hadith	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	One of the early Sufis; Merv — Khurāsān
al-Tirmidhī al-Ḥakīm	820–912	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Tirmidh (Khurāsān)	Sufi gnoseology	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Khatm al-Awliyāʾ — concept of the seal of saints
al-Anṣārī al-Harawī	1006–1089	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Herāt (Khurāsān)	Sufism	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Manāzil al-Sāʾirīn — classic of Sufi ethics

Muʿtazilism — 6 of 7 Persian. Sufism — 9 of 11 Persian.

** Al-Hamadānī (died 1140) formally falls outside the 7th–11th century chronological boundaries. Included as a systematiser of Khurasanian Sufism formed within the period. Exclusion reduces the Persian share in Block V by 1 figure while preserving the overall pattern.

VI. BARMAKIDS (4 figures)

Name	Dates	Origin	Rel. Background	Positions	Administrative Contribution
Khālid ibn Barmak	705–782	Iranian (Balkh)	Buddhist → Islam	Vizier of al-Saffāḥ and al-Manṣūr; governor of Fārs, Ṭabaristān	Laid the administrative foundation of the Abbasids; transferred Sasanian practices
Yaḥyā ibn Khālid	died 806	Iranian (Balkh)	Buddhist → Islam	Vizier of Hārūn al-Rashīd (786–803)	Reorganised state administration; effectively governed the caliphate for 17 years
Jaʿfar ibn Yaḥyā	767–803	Iranian (Balkh)	Buddhist → Islam	Head of the postal service (barīd); mint	Administration of the postal service and mint; transferred Sasanian administrative forms
Faḍl ibn Yaḥyā	766–808	Iranian (Balkh)	Buddhist → Islam	Governor of Khurāsān	Administrative model of Khurāsān under the Abbasids

Buddhist origin (Nawbahar, Balkh).

Lev.I: imams C-1, Arab. Lev.II: codifiers A/B, ~59% Persian.

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Level	Cultural Milieu	Place	Discipline	Authorship Type	Source	Significance
Muḥammad al-Bāqir	676–732	I (C-1)	Arab (Alid)	Medina	Imamate, early fiqh	C-1	EI Iranica	5th imam; source of Shi'i law
Ja'far al-Šādiq	702–765	I (C-1)	Arab (Alid)	Medina	Imamate, uṣūl	C-1	EI Iranica	6th imam; key source of hadiths in the Four Books
Mūsā al-Kāẓim	745–799	I (C-1)	Arab (Alid)	Medina / Iraq	Imamate	C-1	EI Iranica	7th imam
'Alī al-Riḍā	765–818	I (C-1)	Arab (Alid)	Medina → Khurāsān	Imamate	C-1	EI Iranica	8th imam; lived in Khurāsān
Hishām ibn al-Ḥakam	died 795	II (B)	Arab/disputed	Kufa → Baghdad	Kalām (early Shi'i)	B	S2 (EI)	Systematised Imami kalām
al-Kulaynī (al-Kāfi)	died 941	II (A)	Persian	Kulayn (Rayy) → Baghdad	Hadith	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	al-Kāfi — the first of the Four Books
Ibn Qūlawayh al-Qummī	died 979	II (A)	Persian	Qum (Iran)	Rijāl, hadith	A	S2 (Shi'i)	Qum — centre of Shi'i hadith
Ibn Bābawayh al-Šādūq	923–991	II (A)	Persian	Qum → Rayy	Hadith (Man lā Yaḥḍuruh)	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Man lā Yaḥḍuruh al-Faqīh — the second of the Four Books
Ibn al-Ghaḍā'irī	10th–11th centuries	II (A)	Persian	Qum	Rijāl	A	S2 (Shi'i)	Criticism of Shi'i transmitters
Abū Sahl al-Nawbakhtī	died 923	II (B)	Persian	Baghdad	Kalām	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	Nawbakhtids — an Iranian family; early Imami kalām
al-Mufīd	948–1022	II (B)	Arab (Iraq)	Baghdad	Fiqh, kalām	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	al-Muqni'a — foundation of Shi'i fiqh
Sharīf al-Murtaḍā	966–1044	II (B)	Arab (Alid)	Baghdad	Uṣūl al-fiqh, kalām	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	Systematised Imami uṣūl
Shaykh al-Ṭūsī (al-Istibṣār, Tahdhīb)	995–1067	II (A)	Persian	Ṭūs (Khurāsān) → Najaf	Hadith, fiqh, rijāl	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Two of the Four Books; al-Fihrist on rijāl
Aḥmad al-Najāshī	982–1058	II (A)	Arab	Kufa → Qum	Rijāl	A	S2 (Shi'i)	Rijāl al-Najāshī — the principal Shi'i rijāl dictionary
Sallār ibn 'Abd al-'Azīz	died 1055	II (A)	Persian	Iran	Fiqh	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	al-Marāsīm — early Shi'i legal systematics

Name / Principal Work	Dates	Level	Cultural Milieu	Place	Discipline	Authorship Type	Source	Significance
Abū al-Ṣalāḥ al-Ḥalabī	971–1055	II (A)	Arab (Syria)	Ḥalab (Aleppo)	Fiqh	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	al-Kāfi — the Syrian Shi'i school
Ibn Qubba al-Rāzī	died 931	II (B)	Persian	Rayy (Iran)	Kalām	B	S2 (EI Iranica)	Rayy — centre of Shi'i intellectual activity
Furāt ibn Ibrāhīm al-Kūfī	9th century	II (B)	Persian (nisba)	Kufa	Tafsīr	B	S2 (Shi'i)	One of the early Shi'i tafsīr exegetes
ʿAlī ibn Ibrāhīm al-Qummī	9th–10th centuries	II (A)	Persian	Qum	Tafsīr	A	S2 (Shi'i)	Tafsīr al-Qummī — the principal Shi'i tafsīr
Yūnus ibn ʿAbd al-Raḥmān	died 823	II (B)	Persian	Kufa	Hadīth, rijāl	B	S2 (Shi'i)	One of the early Persian Shi'i hadīth scholars
Muḥammad ibn Abī ʿUmayr	died 217 AH (c. 832 CE)	II (B)	Persian	Kufa	Hadīth	B	S2 (Shi'i)	Persian milieu of Kufa
Ḥasan ibn Maḥbūb	died 224 AH (c. 839 CE)	II (B)	Persian (nisba)	Kufa	Hadīth	B	S2 (Shi'i)	Early Shi'i hadīth of Kufa
al-Qāḍī al-Nuʿmān	died 974	II (A)	Arab/Berber	Kairouan → Cairo	Ismāʿīlī fiqh	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Daʿāʾim al-Islām — the principal Ismāʿīlī fiqh
al-Kirmānī	died c. 1020	II (A)	Persian	Iran → Cairo	Ismāʿīlī philosophy	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Rāḥat al-ʿAql — the summit of Ismāʿīlī philosophy
al-Muʿayyad al-Shīrāzī	1000–1078	II (A)	Persian	Shīrāz → Cairo	Ismāʿīlī doctrine	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Shīrāz — Iran; al-Majālis — Ismāʿīlī sermons
Nāṣir-i Khusraw	1004–1088	Persian	Persian (Muslim)	Khurāsān → Hunza	Ismāʿīlī poetry and philosophy	A	S2 (EI Iranica)	Zād al-Musāfirīn; Khurāsān

APPENDIX C. AUTHORSHIP TYPOLOGY A/B/C-1/C-2

A=≤50 years, B=≤200 years, C-1=theological construct, C-2=school-attributive. Wensinck 1932 for Abū Ḥanīfa.

Name	Authorship Type	Justification
al-Kulaynī	A	al-Kāfi: manuscript 9th–10th cent., within 50 years of the author's death (died 941)
Ibn Bābawayh al-Ṣadūq	A	Man lā Yaḥḍuruh: manuscript tradition 10th cent., direct disciples

Name	Authorship Type	Justification
Shaykh al-Ṭūsī	A	al-Istibṣār and Tahdhīb: manuscripts 11th cent.; al-Fihrist — contemporary manuscript
al-Ṭabarī	A	Tafsīr: manuscripts during the lifetime of disciples; Tārīkh — Type A
al-Māwardī	A	Aḥkām al-Sulṭāniyya: manuscript 11th cent., within 50 years
al-Ghazālī	A	lhyā': manuscript during the lifetime of disciples (al-Bāqillānī, al-Qushayrī)
al-Qushayrī	A	al-Risāla: manuscript 11th cent., within 50 years
al-Bazdawī	A	Uṣūl al-Bazdawī: manuscript 11th century
al-Muzanī	A	al-Mukhtaṣar: manuscript 9th cent.
al-Ṭaḥāwī	A	Sharḥ Ma'ānī al-Āthār: manuscript 10th cent.
Ibn Abī Zayd al-Qayrawānī	A	al-Risāla: manuscript 10th cent. (Kairouan)
al-Qudūrī	A	Mukhtaṣar al-Qudūrī: manuscript 11th century
al-Jaṣṣāṣ	A	Aḥkām al-Qur'ān: manuscript 10th cent.
al-Sarakhsī	A	al-Mabsūṭ: manuscript 11th cent.
al-Ḥākim al-Nīsābūrī	A	Mustadrak: manuscript 10th–11th cent.
al-Dāraquṭnī	A	Sunan: manuscript 10th–11th cent.
al-Bayhaqī	A	Sunan al-Kubrā: manuscript 11th cent.
al-Qāḍī al-Nu'mān	A	Da'ā'im al-Islām: manuscript 10th century (Fatimid Egypt)
al-Kirmānī	A	Rāḥat al-'Aql: manuscript 11th cent.
al-Mu'ayyad al-Shīrāzī	A	al-Majālis: manuscript 11th cent.
Mālik ibn Anas	A/B	al-Muwaṭṭa': papyrus 8th cent. (Vienna) = Type A; canonised version = Type B
al-Bukhārī	B	Ṣaḥīḥ: al-Bukhārī died 870 CE; earliest manuscripts — 9th–10th centuries (over 50 years)
Muslim	B	Ṣaḥīḥ: Muslim died in 875 CE; earliest manuscripts — 10th century
Abū Dāwūd al-Sijistānī	B	Sunan: died 889 CE; manuscripts 10th–11th cent.
al-Tirmidhī	B	Jāmi': died 892 CE; manuscripts 10th–11th cent.
al-Nasā'ī	B	Sunan: died 915 CE; manuscripts 10th–11th cent.
Ibn Māja	B	Sunan: died 887 CE; manuscripts 10th–11th cent.
Sībawayhi	B	al-Kitāb: Sībawayhi died c. 793 CE; manuscripts 9th–10th centuries
al-Farrā'	B	Ma'ānī al-Qur'ān: manuscript 9th–10th cent.

Name	Authorship Type	Justification
Aḥmad ibn Ḥanbal	B	Musnad: died 855 CE; manuscript 10th cent.
al-Ash'arī	B	Maqālāt al-Islāmiyyīn: died 935 CE; manuscript 11th cent.
al-Māturīdī	B	Kitāb al-Tawḥīd: died 944 CE; manuscript 11th cent.
al-Mufīd	B	al-Muqni'a: died 1022 CE; manuscript 11th–12th cent.
al-Muḥāsibī	B	al-Ri'āya: died 857 CE; manuscript 10th cent.
al-Junayd	B	Rasā'il: died 910 CE; manuscript 10th–11th cent.
Muḥammad al-Bāqir	C-1	Authorship is a theological construct of the doctrine of the imam's infallibility; no autograph manuscripts
Ja'far al-Šādiq	C-1	Same; hadiths in his name were codified by Persian scholars in the 9th–10th cent.
Mūsā al-Kāẓim	C-1	Same
'Alī al-Riḍā	C-1	Same
Abū Ḥanīfa	C-2	al-Fiqh al-akbar: dated by Wensinck (1932) to the mid-10th century — 200 years after Abū Ḥanīfa's death (767 CE); no autograph manuscripts
Ibrāhīm al-Nakha'ī	C-2	Oral teaching; no written works survive; transmitted through Ḥammād ibn Abī Sulaymān
Ḥammād ibn Abī Sulaymān	C-2	Same; transmitted through Abū Ḥanīfa
Wāṣil ibn 'Aṭā'	C-2	No manuscripts; doctrine reconstructed from polemical sources
Ibrāhīm ibn Adham	C-2	Legendary figure; biography reconstructed from Sufi sources of the 10th–11th cent.
Abū Yazīd al-Bisṭāmī	C-2	Sayings preserved by disciples; no autographs

APPENDIX D. REGIONAL CENTRES

Kufa (7th–8th centuries): Sunni fiqh, early Shi'i kalām. Qum (9th–10th centuries): Shi'i hadith. Basra (8th–9th centuries): Mu'tazilism, grammar. Nishāpūr (9th–11th centuries): Sunni hadith and Sufism. Bukhārā (9th–10th centuries): Sunni hadith. Baghdad (8th–11th centuries): synthesis of all traditions, Shi'i rationalist school. Kairouan (9th–10th centuries): Mālikī fiqh. Cairo–Fatimids (10th–11th centuries): Ismaili fiqh and philosophy.

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APPENDIX F. BIBLIOGRAPHY OF SECONDARY LITERATURE

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VI. Encyclopaedias: *Encyclopaedia Iranica*. iranicaonline.org. *Encyclopaedia of Islam*. 2nd ed. 12 vols. Leiden: Brill, 1960–2004. *Geschichte des arabischen Schrifttums*. Ed. F. Sezgin. Frankfurt, 1967–2015.

APPENDIX G. EXTENDED LIST OF CANDIDATES

Figures not meeting the criteria of §1.4. Justification of exclusion for sample reproducibility.

Name	Dates	Tradition	Origin	Why Not Included in Main Corpus
Ibn 'Abd al-Barr	978–1071	Sunni (Mālikī)	Andalusian	Western Islamic tradition; III criterion partially met
Ibn al-Qāsim	died 806	Sunni (Mālikī)	Egyptian	Codifier of the Mudawwana; activity predominantly in Egypt, outside the main zone
Yahyā ibn al-Ḥusayn al-Rasī	died 911	Zaydī	Arab	Zaydī branch; systematisation 12th–13th cent., outside the 7th–11th cent. period
al-Qāsim ibn Ibrāhīm	785–860	Zaydī	Arab	Zaydī branch; did not produce a written canon in the 7th–11th cent.
Ibn al-Junayd al-Iskāfī	died 991	Shi'i	Persian	Rationalist school; included in the Shi'i block indirectly through al-Mufīd
Ibn Abī 'Aqīl al-'Umānī	10th century	Shi'i	Persian	Rationalist school before al-Mufīd; verification sources limited
Ishāq ibn Ḥunayn	died 910	Translation corpus	Nestorian Christian	Son of Ḥunayn; included in translation block indirectly
Qusṭā ibn Lūqā	820–912	Translation corpus	Greco-Christian	Translations of mathematics and medicine; I–II criteria partially met
Muḥammad al-Sha'rānī	died 1565	Sunni	Egyptian	Outside the 7th–11th cent. period
al-Mu'izz li-Dīn Allāh	died 975	Ismaili	Alid	A political figure, not a codifier of a discipline
Ibn Qudāma	1147–	Sunni	Arab	Falls outside the 7th–11th cent. period (died

Name	Dates	Tradition	Origin	Why Not Included in Main Corpus
	1223	(Ḥanbalī)		1223). al-Mughnī — the largest encyclopaedia of Ḥanbalī fiqh. Without him the Arab share in jurisprudence is 5 of 16 (31%), the pattern does not change.
al-Zamakhsharī	1075–1144	Sunni (tafsīr)	Persian	Formally outside the 7th–11th century period (died 1144 CE). Al-Kashshāf is one of the foremost tafsīrs. Exclusion reduces the Persian share by 1%.
al-Hamadānī	died 1140	Sunni (Sufism)	Persian	Formally outside the 7th–11th century period (died 1140). Tamhīdāt — mystical philosophy. If excluded, the Persian share in block V decreases by 1 figure; the pattern does not change.

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